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TAB 6



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-284-24/25, **Version:** 1

Agenda Date: 4/8/2025

In Control: Multilingual and Multicultural Department

Official LAUSD Land Acknowledgement

Multilingual Multicultural Education Department

Brief Description:

(Official LAUSD Land Acknowledgement) Recommends adoption of the proposed Land Acknowledgement developed in consultation with local tribes.

Action Proposed:

Adopt a Los Angeles Unified School District spoken and written land acknowledgment statement (Attachment A).

Background:

The Los Angeles Unified School District (Los Angeles Unified, LAUSD, or District) is committed to honoring the cultures, histories, and perspectives of local tribes and fostering an inclusive environment that recognizes and celebrates the contributions and experiences of Indigenous peoples in the Greater Los Angeles Basin.

The Los Angeles Unified School District (District) occupies land originally inhabited and still cared for by the Gabrieleño and Fernandeno Tataviam tribes. The region of Tovaranga, now known as the Greater Los Angeles Basin, is the distinct homeland of the present-day Gabrieleño/Tongva, whose origins trace back to the cultures preceding the establishment of the San Gabriel Mission, from which the name "Gabrieleño" was derived. The Fernandeno Tataviam People inhabited the northern region of Los Angeles County and eastern Ventura County, including areas such as San Fernando, Simi Valley, Santa Clarita, and Antelope Valleys, and their culture predates the establishment of Mission San Fernando, from which the name "Fernandeno" originated. The District has a large American Indian/Alaska Native and Indigenous student population, and continues efforts to support families with the self-identification process.

On November 19, 2024, the Board of Education (Board) adopted the *Reckoning with Our Past, Honoring our Present: Developing a Los Angeles Unified Land Acknowledgement* Resolution (Res-017-24/25), which called for the District to collaborate with local recognized tribes to develop a public land acknowledgement statement, among other things. The proposed land acknowledgment statement (Attachment A) was developed in consultation with representatives from the San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians and the Fernandeno Tataviam Band of Mission Indians. Tribal consultations, held on February 13 and 26, 2025, fostered open dialogue, and the collaboration enabled the development of a respectful and authentic land acknowledgment statement. Tribal leaders from the following tribes were also invited to participate and provide consultation:

- Gabrieleno/Tongva San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians
- Gabrielino/Tongva Nation of the Greater Los Angeles Basin
- Gabrielino Tongva Indians of California Tribal Council
- Gabrielino-Tongva Tribe
- Gabrieleno Kizh Nation

To support educators, the Multilingual and Multicultural Education Department (MMED) compiled educational resources to raise awareness about the history of the land and its Indigenous peoples (Attachment B). Through these and other efforts, LAUSD aims to integrate Native and Indigenous perspectives into its educational framework. The commitment includes developing resources for Ethnic Studies and ensuring the curriculum reflects Indigenous histories and cultures.

Expected Outcomes:

The Board will adopt the proposed spoken and written land acknowledgment statement (Attachment A), which staff will subsequently post on the District website with the referenced educational resources (Attachment B). The statement will serve as both recognition and an educational tool, integrating Indigenous perspectives into curricula and promoting inclusivity for Native students and families.

Beyond symbolism, the acknowledgment affirms LAUSD's commitment to equity and social justice, strengthening relationships with Indigenous communities and encouraging ongoing dialogue about reconciliation. By implementing a land acknowledgment, LAUSD takes a meaningful step toward fostering respect, inclusion, and accountability while creating a more informed and equitable school community.

Board Options and Consequences:

A "YES" vote will authorize the adoption of the land acknowledgment statement, which will be published on the District's website with accompanying educational resources and tools for students and school communities to utilize.

If the Board votes "NO", a formal land acknowledgment statement will not be adopted.

Policy Implications:

Not applicable.

Budget Impact:

The land acknowledgement statement will be posted on various District webpages and does not impact the budget otherwise.

Student Impact:

A land acknowledgment statement can have a profound impact on students by fostering cultural awareness and education. It provides an opportunity for students to learn about the history, culture, and contributions of Indigenous communities, encouraging a deeper understanding and respect for the original inhabitants of the land. This kind of recognition not only raises awareness but also helps create a more inclusive environment by affirming the cultural heritage of Indigenous students, promoting a sense of belonging and respect for all cultures within the school community.

In addition, it encourages critical thinking by prompting students to reflect on history, colonization, and the ongoing challenges faced by Native American and Indigenous communities. Such discussions can open the door to important conversations about social justice, equity, and reconciliation. For Native American and Indigenous students, seeing their heritage acknowledged can be empowering, offering a sense of validation and connection within the school environment.

A land acknowledgment statement also fosters a connection to the land itself, encouraging students to recognize the importance of environmental stewardship and their place in the broader community. In this way, a land acknowledgment statement not only educates but also nurtures empathy, respect, and a deeper understanding of the world around them.

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	4	The land acknowledgement statement addresses historical inequities by recognizing the Gabrieleno and Fernandeño Tataviam tribes, acknowledging colonization's lasting impacts, and countering Indigenous erasure. Beyond symbolism, it promotes reconciliation through education, fostering awareness, and institutional accountability to support Indigenous communities.
Resource Prioritization	4	By committing to learn about Native American Indigenous histories, cultures, and fostering relationships with these communities, it ensures that Native American and Indigenous students are recognized and their needs are addressed through culturally relevant resources, educational support, and programs aimed at healing and unity.
Results	4	This will help close achievement gaps by fostering cultural awareness, empowering Indigenous students, and encouraging policies that support their unique needs. When paired with meaningful actions, it creates a more inclusive, supportive environment that promotes academic success and community engagement.
TOTAL	12	

Issues and Analysis:

The District is taking significant strides toward honoring Indigenous communities by developing a thoughtful land acknowledgment statement. This initiative is rooted in collaboration with local Indigenous groups, particularly the San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians - Gabrielino Tongva and the Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians, whose insights have shaped a respectful and authentic acknowledgment of the land's history. By engaging with tribal leaders and integrating Indigenous perspectives into its educational framework, LAUSD is committed to fostering an inclusive environment that recognizes and celebrates the contributions and experiences of Indigenous peoples in the Greater Los Angeles Basin.

Next Steps:

- **Implementation of Educational Resources:** Launch the compiled resources for educators, making them accessible through the LAUSD website and providing guidelines on how to effectively incorporate Indigenous perspectives into classroom discussions.

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- Professional Development Workshops: Schedule ongoing professional development sessions for educators, focusing on Indigenous histories, cultures, and current issues, and ensuring these sessions are well-attended and impactful.
- Community Engagement: Continue engaging with Indigenous communities through regular meetings and feedback sessions, fostering a relationship of trust and collaboration.
- Promotion and Awareness Campaign: Create a campaign to promote awareness of land acknowledgment statement and educational initiatives among students, parents, and the wider community, highlighting the importance of Indigenous histories and cultures.
- Support for Indigenous Students: Develop additional initiatives aimed at supporting Indigenous students.
- Feedback Mechanism: Establish a system for gathering feedback from educators, students, and community members regarding the effectiveness of the initiatives and areas for improvement.
- Long-term Partnerships: Build lasting partnerships with the San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians, the Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians, and other Indigenous groups to ensure ongoing collaboration and support for Indigenous education within LAUSD.

Pursuant to the *Reckoning with Our Past, Honoring our Present: Developing a Los Angeles Unified Land Acknowledgement* Resolution, the District explored the feasibility and options for honoring the history of the land occupied by the District and atoning for past injustices. The report of finding are attached (Attachment C).

Attachments:

Attachment A - LAUSD Land Acknowledgement

Attachment B - Land Acknowledgment Educational Resources

Attachment C - Report of Findings

Submitted:

03/28/25

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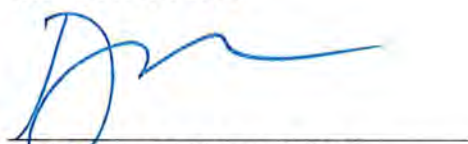
RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


 ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
 Superintendent

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


 LYDIA ACOSTA STEPHENS
 Executive Director
 Multilingual Multicultural Education
 Department

REVIEWED BY:


 DEVORA NAVERA REED
 General Counsel

☒ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


 ANTHONY AGUILAR
 Chief of Special Education and
 Specialized Programs

REVIEWED BY:


 NOLBERTO DELGADILLO
 Deputy Chief Business Officer, Finance

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

APPROVED BY:


 KARLA V. ESTRADA
 Deputy Superintendent of Instruction

ATTACHMENT A

LAUSD Land Acknowledgment Statement

Spoken Version:

We acknowledge that the Los Angeles Unified School District is located on lands traditionally stewarded by the Gabrieleño and Fernandeño Tataviam peoples. We recognize the Gabrieleño as the original caretakers of the Los Angeles Basin and the Fernandeño Tataviam as guardians of the northern valleys.

As we learn and grow, we commit to understanding Indigenous histories and cultures, fostering relationships with these communities, and contributing to healing and unity.

Written Version:

We acknowledge that the Los Angeles Unified School District operates on land originally and still inhabited and cared for by the Gabrieleño and Fernandeño Tataviam peoples, who have stewarded this land for generations.

We recognize these Indigenous communities' ongoing presence and contributions and honor their connection to this region.

We recognize Gabrieleño people as the original stewards of the Los Angeles Basin, and the nearby coastal lands, and the Fernandeño Tataviam as protectors of the northern valleys. These lands have and continue to hold deep cultural and spiritual significance to their people and have shaped the community we live in today.

We pay our respects to the Honuukvetam (Ancestors), ‘Ahihirom (Elders), and ‘Eyoohiinkem (our relatives/relations) past, present, and emerging and commit to supporting Indigenous communities through education ensuring their voices are heard and their legacies are respected.

We commit to deepening our understanding of the histories and cultures of the Native peoples of this land. This acknowledgment demonstrates our ongoing efforts to build and sustain relationships with Indigenous communities and contribute to healing and reconciliation.

Land Acknowledgement Educational Resources

A formal land acknowledgment is a statement that recognizes an area's original inhabitants, those who have been forcibly dispossessed of their homelands, and is a step toward recognizing the negative impacts these communities have endured and continue to endure as a result. It makes clear that the First Peoples are still here, and they have not left their ancestral lands.

The National Museum of the American Indian (2023) emphasizes the importance of land acknowledgments as a means of honoring the original stewards of the lands that schools and communities reside on. This initiative is best accomplished through meaningful consultation with local Indigenous communities and Native Nations, promoting respectful and continuous relationships.

Visit the following websites to learn more about land acknowledgements, including the ancestral lands LAUSD schools and communities currently reside in. These resources are provided for the reader's information and may be updated from time to time by the District. Inclusion does not imply official endorsement by LA Unified; omissions are not intended to be exclusionary in nature.

RESOURCES	
Why a land acknowledgment?	The Multilingual Multicultural Education Department (MMED) created a webpage that provides educational resources and additional information about the San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians and the Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians.
https://native-land.ca/	This website provides an interactive map that can be used to learn about the lands schools and communities reside in.
Tovaangar: Interactive and Self-Guided Exploration of Tongva Villages in Los Angeles	Finding Tovaangar inspires readers to engage with interactive maps that unveil the rich heritage of Tongva villages in what is now known as Los Angeles County.
Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians: Villages in Los Angeles	Information about the citizens of the Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians who are the people of northern Los Angeles County.
National Museum of the American Indian Smithsonian Native Knowledge 360	The National Museum of the American Indian provides numerous resources for educators looking to learn more about land acknowledgments.
Countywide Land Acknowledgement Implementation Guide	In October 2021, LA County gathered input from the region's First Peoples on historical harms with the goal to create a formal land acknowledgment for the County. Find tips for other organizations looking to develop their own land acknowledgments.
Native Governance Center	Beyond Land Acknowledgement: A Guide. The guide is based on the content of the Native Governance Center held the "Moving Beyond Land Acknowledgment" event held on August 25, 2021.
MMED Title VI American Indian/Alaskan Native & Indigenous Education Program	District compiled resources to support awareness of the land's history and its Indigenous peoples.

ATTACHMENT C

Report of Findings
Board Resolution 017-24/25: Reckoning with Our Past, Honoring Our Present: Developing a Los Angeles Unified Land Acknowledgement

The District explored the feasibility and options for honoring the history of the land occupied by the District and atoning for past injustices, below is the report of findings.

Providing professional development to all educators on native histories and the impact of colonization.

The Title VI American Indian and Indigenous Education Program provides professional development focused on Native history and student support, promoting critical thinking, challenging traditional narratives, and fostering an appreciation for Native and Indigenous cultural strengths.

LAUSD integrates Native and Indigenous communities into its Ethnic Studies curriculum, emphasizing their history, resilience, and ongoing struggles for sovereignty. To support educators, the Ethnic Studies Leadership Team provides resources and lessons on Indigenous histories and cultures. The Ethnic Studies Best Practices Video highlights an American Indian Studies class, using critical questioning to challenge dominant narratives and promote counter-narratives.

Moreover, to further exemplify the District's commitment to uplifting and validating Native and Indigenous identities, the Title VI American Indian and Indigenous program partnered with local tribes to provide professional learning sessions to educators across LAUSD. Educators learned about the context and connections between the co-developed land acknowledgement statement and historical accounts of tribal lineages from across Southern California.

Providing an update on and promoting the Indigenous student identification campaign, and the goal of better capturing the number of American Indian/Alaskan Native and Indigenous students served by the District.

In August 2024, the Multilingual Multicultural Education Department (MMED) launched the American Indian/Alaska Native and Indigenous Family Questionnaire, now part of the enrollment packet. This initiative has already received 254 eligible applications. The questionnaire aims to collect essential information to better tailor educational resources and services for Indigenous students and families.

Campaign Efforts:

- *By March 2025, campaign posters had been distributed to all school sites.*
- *Ongoing School Office Staff Support sessions to enhance staff's ability to assist families with the Title VI ED 506 form and new enrollment processes.*
- *Parent Engagement presentations during the Fall Family Academy and February 2025 DELAC meeting.*

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Inclusion of stories, literature, and instruction that centers native voice and native tribes throughout the curricula (especially in grades TK-8), and update on the implementation of AB1703 and AB1821.

To enrich the curriculum, several resources provided by the Ethnic Studies department focus on native voices and tribes:

- *American Indian Studies Textbook: Offers foundational knowledge supporting the core curriculum*
- *Optional Course Reader: Provides articles and perspectives from the Native American community for deeper insights*
- *Books/Texts for Teacher Growth: A curated list includes works by Native American authors to enhance understanding of colonization and marginalization impacts*

In May 2024, LAUSD libraries received kits with books by Native American and Indigenous authors. By Fall 2024, classroom kits with various titles were distributed to every elementary grade level and secondary ELA classroom. In late Spring 2024, the American Indian and Indigenous Teacher Cadre was established to develop responsive lesson plans using these books.

Review school names and mascots to ensure compliance with existing policies around cultural sensitivities and affirmations, in alignment with AB 3074.

Results of the evaluation determined that no mascots violate District policies or cultural sensitivity standards, confirming that our practices align with our commitment to respecting diverse communities. The District remains dedicated to working with school communities to ensure a respectful educational environment.

Ensure the continued provision of a dedicated position to work with the San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians, the Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians and other tribes in alignment with the current efforts of the Multilingual and Multicultural Education Department.

In the 2023–24 school year, the District introduced two roles to enhance support for American Indian and Indigenous students: the Title VI American Indian and Indigenous Education Coordinator and the Teacher Expert. These positions focus on addressing unique educational needs, advancing Title VI program goals, and reinforcing the District’s commitment to equitable, culturally relevant education. Continued funding for these roles is included in the proposed 2025–26 budget, pending Board adoption.

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- Prioritizing the inclusion of native plants in the District's design plans for outdoor improvements and greening projects.
- Increasing the representation of native artists in the painting of murals on school campuses.
- Including names of original tribal villages and places on sites that schools now occupy through plaques or other physical commemorations.

To promote increased campus greening, the Facilities Services Division (Facilities) has design specifications that prioritize the use of native plants wherever possible. If the Approved Plant List does not include certain native plants, they may be requested for evaluation whereby each plant species will undergo a safety assessment. Plants that are poisonous, have injurious thorns, or are invasive cannot be approved.

To celebrate cultural diversity and enrich our educational environments, Facilities will encourage the incorporation of native artist representation in campus modernization projects (e.g. seismic modernizations, major modernizations, and classroom replacements) that include murals. Additionally, Maintenance and Operations staff are available to support schools that embark on their own mural projects. These projects must adhere to Policy Bulletin No. 5761.0 ([link](#)). School Administrators should consult with their Complex Project Managers for further guidance and information.

Facilities supports efforts to recognize the history of original tribal villages. While Facilities staff does not install plaques directly, we collaborate with school sites to identify appropriate locations for commemorative markers. Schools interested in installing plaques can work with the appropriate District departments to explore funding and implementation options.

Providing resources to educators in recognition of Indigenous People's Day, National Day of Remembrance, California Native American Day, Native American Heritage Month, and, where appropriate, National Awareness Day for Missing or Murdered Indigenous Women and Girls.

Lessons on Native communities, their histories, and the impacts of colonization are incorporated into:

- *Equity Action Network's Ethnic Studies presentation for new teachers*
- *Summer 2024 Cultural Heritage Enrichment course*
- *Ethnic Studies and History Social Science Parent Webinar*
- *Resources in the Ethnic Studies Schoology Group, highlighting Native/Indigenous experiences and voices*

MMED created interactive slide decks on Indigenous education and awareness:

- *Land Acknowledgments*
- *[Native American Heritage Month](#)*
- *[National Day of Remembrance](#)*
- *[Indigenous Peoples' Day](#)*

ATTACHMENT C

Options for formally observing Indigenous People's Day as part of the District's instructional calendar.

The Division of School Operations reviewed instructional calendars from the 1980s and 1990s, finding no record of Columbus Day/Indigenous Peoples' Day being observed, even during the year-round school period. To designate the second Monday in October as Indigenous Peoples' Day and make it an unassigned day, an extra day must be added to the first semester to meet P.E. requirements for 4X4 schools. This change would also require negotiations with labor partners due to its impact on employees' work schedules. Indigenous People's Day is included in the LAUSD Calendar of Commemorative Dates.

Investing financial resources in the preservation of tribal cultural education and land resources to lift the San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians and the Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians, including but not limited to, restoring and preserving Gabrielino Tongva Springs and supporting tribal stewardship opportunities.

The Multilingual Multicultural Education Department is collaborating with local tribes to improve cultural competence among LAUSD educators. This initiative focuses on enhancing understanding of tribal histories and contemporary issues, integrating authentic tribal education into the curriculum. Aligned with the American Indian and Indigenous Student Comprehensive Plan, it promotes culturally relevant teaching. Educators will participate in workshops and training to learn about Indigenous contributions and challenges, ensuring educational equity by incorporating Indigenous perspectives within LAUSD.

Facilities has engaged in discussions with tribal representatives regarding extension agreements for sacred springs preservation, and while no specific funding has been identified for such initiatives, staff will continue to collaborate with MMED to pursue alternative funding opportunities for these important cultural preservation efforts.